

ORLANDO

Are you native of this place?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

As the cony that you see dwell where she is kindled.

ORLANDO

Your accent is something finer than you could purchase in so removed a dwelling.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

I have been told so of many. But indeed an old religious uncle of mine taught me to speak, who was in his youth an inland man, one that knew courtship too well, for there he fell in love. I have heard him read many lectures against it, and I thank God I am not a woman, to be touched with so many giddy offences as he hath generally taxed their whole sex withal.

ORLANDO

Can you remember any of the principal evils that he laid to the charge of women?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

There were none principal. They were all like one another as halfpence are, every one fault seeming monstrous till his fellow fault came to match it.

ORLANDO

I prithee recount some of them.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

No, I will not cast away my physic but on those that are sick. There is a man haunts the forest that abuses our young plants with carving ‘Rosalind’ on their barks, hangs odes upon hawthorns and elegies on brambles, all, forsooth, deifying the name of Rosalind. If I could meet that fancy-monger, I would give him some good counsel, for he seems to have the quotidian of love upon him.

ORLANDO

I am he that is so love-shaked. I pray you tell me your remedy.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

There is none of my uncle’s marks upon you. He taught me how to know a man in love, in which cage of rushes I am sure you are not prisoner.

ORLANDO

What were his marks?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

A lean cheek, which you have not; a blue eye and sunken, which you have not; an unquestionable spirit, which you have not; a beard neglected, which you have not—but I pardon you for that, for simply your having in beard is a younger brother’s revenue. Then your hose should be ungartered, your bonnet unbanded, your sleeve unbuttoned, your shoe untied, and everything about you demonstrating a careless desolation. But you are no such man. You are rather point-device in your accouterments, as loving yourself than seeming the lover of any other.

ORLANDO

Fair youth, I would I could make thee believe I love.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Me believe it? You may as soon make her that you love believe it, which I warrant she is apter to do than to confess she does. That is one of the points in the which women still give the lie to their consciences. But, in good sooth, are you he that hangs the verses on the trees wherein Rosalind is so admired?

ORLANDO

I swear to thee, youth, by the white hand of Rosalind, I am that he, that unfortunate he.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

But are you so much in love as your rhymes speak?

ORLANDO

Neither rhyme nor reason can express how much.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Love is merely a madness, and, I tell you, deserves as well a dark house and a whip as madmen do; and the reason why they are not so punished and cured is that the lunacy is so ordinary that the whippers are in love too. Yet I profess curing it by counsel.

ORLANDO

Did you ever cure any so?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Yes, one, and in this manner. He was to imagine me his love, his mistress, and I set him every day to woo me; at which time would I, being but a moonish youth, grieve, be effeminate, changeable, longing and liking, proud, fantastical, apish, shallow, inconstant, full of tears, full of smiles; for every passion something, and for no passion truly anything, as boys and women are, for the most part, cattle of this colour; would now like him, now loathe him; then entertain him, then forswear him; now weep for him, then spit at him, that I drave my suitor from his mad humour of love to a living humour of madness, which was to forswear the full stream of the world and to live in a nook merely monastic. And thus I cured him, and this way will I take upon me to wash your liver as clean as a sound sheep's heart, that there shall not be one spot of love in't.

ORLANDO

I would not be cured, youth.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

I would cure you if you would but call me Rosalind and come every day to my cote and woo me.

ORLANDO

Now, by the faith of my love, I will. Tell me where it is.

ORLANDO

I prithee, who doth he trot withal?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Marry, he trots hard with a young maid between the contract of her marriage and the day it is solemnized. If the interim be but a se'night, time's pace is so hard that it seems the length of seven year.

ORLANDO

Who ambles time withal?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

With a priest that lacks Latin and a rich man that hath not the gout, for the one sleeps easily because he cannot study, and the other lives merrily because he feels no pain—the one lacking the burden of lean and wasteful learning, the other knowing no burden of heavy tedious penury. These time ambles withal.

ORLANDO

Who doth he gallop withal?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

With a thief to the gallows, for though he go as softly as foot can fall, he thinks himself too soon there.

ORLANDO

Who stays it still withal?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

With lawyers in the vacation, for they sleep between term and term, and then they perceive not how time moves.

ORLANDO

Where dwell you, pretty youth?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

With this shepherdess, my sister, here in the skirts of the forest, like fringe upon a petticoat.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Go with me to it, and I'll show it you; and by the way you shall tell me where in the forest you live. Will you go?

ORLANDO

With all my heart, good youth.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Nay, you must call me Rosalind.—Come, sister, will you go?

(Exeunt omnes.)



I WILL SPEAK TO HIM LIKE A SAUCY LACKEY



JAQUES

There I shall see mine own figure.

ORLANDO

Which I take to be either a fool or a cipher.

JAQUES

I'll tarry no longer with you. Farewell, good Signior Love.

ORLANDO

I am glad of your departure. Adieu, good Monsieur Melancholy.

(Exit JAQUES.)

ROSALIND

[Aside to CELIA] I will speak to him like a saucy lackey, and under that habit play the knave with him.

(As GANYMEDE)

Do you hear, forester?

ORLANDO

Very well. What would you?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

I pray you, what is 't o'clock?

ORLANDO

You should ask me what time o' day. There's no clock in the forest.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Then there is no true lover in the forest; else sighing every minute and groaning every hour would detect the lazy foot of time as well as a clock.

ORLANDO

And why not the swift foot of time? Had not that been as proper?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

By no means, sir. Time travels in divers paces with divers persons. I'll tell you who time ambles withal, who time trots withal, who time gallops withal, and who he stands still withal.

AUDREY

JACQUES

I do not like her name.

ORLANDO

There was no thought of pleasing you when she was christened.

JACQUES

What stature is she of?

ORLANDO

Just as high as my heart.

JACQUES

You are full of pretty answers. Have you not been acquainted with goldsmiths' wives and conned them out of rings?

ORLANDO

Not so. But I answer you right painted cloth, from whence you have studied your questions.

JACQUES

You have a nimble wit. I think 'twas made of Atalanta's heels. Will you sit down with me? And we two will rail against our mistress the world and all our misery.

ORLANDO

I will chide no breather in the world but myself, against whom I know most faults.

JACQUES

The worst fault you have is to be in love.

ORLANDO

'Tis a fault I will not change for your best virtue. I am weary of you.

JACQUES

By my troth, I was seeking for a fool when I found you.

ORLANDO

He is drowned in the brook. Look but in, and you shall see him.

Scene 3

The Forest of Arden

(Enter TOUCHSTONE and AUDREY, followed by JACQUES)

TOUCHSTONE

Come apace, good Audrey. I will fetch up your goats, Audrey. And how, Audrey? Am I the man yet? Doth my simple feature content you?

AUDREY

Your features, Lord warrant us! What features?

TOUCHSTONE

I am here with thee and thy goats, as the most capricious poet, honest Ovid, was among the Goths.

JACQUES

[Aside] O knowledge ill-inhabited, worse than love in a thatched house.

TOUCHSTONE

When a man's verses cannot be understood, nor a man's good wit seconded with the forward child, understanding, it strikes a man more dead than a great reckoning in a little room. Truly, I would the gods had made thee poetical.

AUDREY

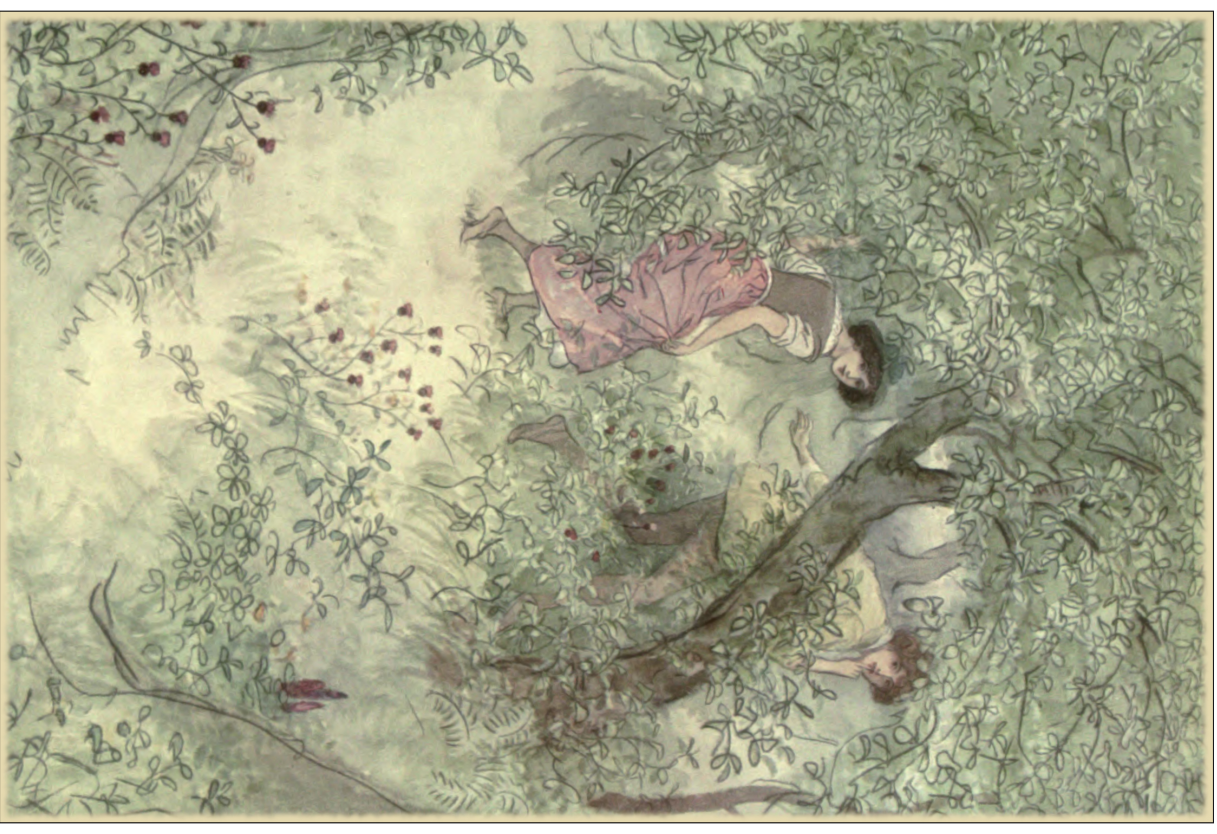
I do not know what 'poetical' is. Is it honest in deed and word? Is it a true thing?

TOUCHSTONE

No, truly, for the truest poetry is the most feigning, and lovers are given to poetry, and what they swear in poetry may be said as lovers they do feign.



I WOULD THE GODS HAD MADE THEE POETICAL



'TIS HE. SLINK BY, AND NOTE HIM.

ROSALIND

Do you not know I am a woman? When I think, I must speak.
Sweet, say on.

CELIA

You bring me out.

(*Enter ORLANDO AND JAQUES.*)

Soft, comes he not here?

ROSALIND

'Tis he. Slink by, and note him.

(*ROSALIND and CELIA step aside.*)

JAQUES

(*To ORLANDO*)

I thank you for your company, but, good faith, I had as lief have
been myself alone.

ORLANDO

And so had I, but yet, for fashion sake, I thank you too for your
society.

JAQUES

God be wi' you. Let's meet as little as we can.

ORLANDO

I do desire we may be better strangers.

JAQUES

I pray you mar no more trees with writing love songs in their barks.

ORLANDO

I pray you mar no more of my verses with reading them
ill-favouredly.

JAQUES

Rosalind is your love's name?

ORLANDO

Yes, just.

AUDREY

Do you wish, then, that the gods had made me poetical?

TOUCHSTONE

I do, truly, for thou swear'st to me thou art honest. Now if thou
wert a poet, I might have some hope thou didst feign.

AUDREY

Would you not have me honest?

TOUCHSTONE

No, truly, unless thou wert hard-favoured; for honesty coupled to
beauty is to have honey a sauce to sugar.

JAQUES

(*Aside*) *A material fool.*

AUDREY

Well, I am not fair, and therefore I pray the gods make me honest.

TOUCHSTONE

Truly, and to cast away honesty upon a foul slut were to put good
meat into an unclean dish.

AUDREY

I am not a slut, though I thank the gods I am foul.

TOUCHSTONE

Well, praised be the gods for thy foulness; slutishness may come
hereafter. But be it as it may be, I will marry thee; and to that end I
have been with Sir Oliver Martext, the vicar of the next village, who
hath promised to meet me in this place of the forest and to couple
us.

JAQUES

(*Aside*) *I would fain see this meeting.*

AUDREY

Well, the gods give us joy.

TOUCHSTONE

Amen. A man may, if he were of a fearful heart, stagger in this attempt, for here we have no temple but the wood, no assembly but horn-beasts. But what though? Courage. As horns are odious, they are necessary. It is said 'Many a man knows no end of his goods.' Right: many a man has good horns and knows no end of them. Well, that is the dowry of his wife; 'tis none of his own getting. Horns? Even so. Poor men alone? No, no. The noblest deer hath them as huge as the rascal. Is the single man therefore blessed? No. As a walled town is more worthier than a village, so is the forehead of a married man more honourable than the bare brow of a bachelor. And by how much defence is better than no skill, by so much is a horn more precious than to want.

(Enter SIR OLIVER MARTEXT.)

Here comes Sir Oliver.—Sir Oliver Martext, you are well met. Will you dispatch us here under this tree, or shall we go with you to your chapel?

OLIVER MARTEXT

Is there none here to give the woman?

TOUCHSTONE

I will not take her on gift of any man.

OLIVER MARTEXT

Truly, she must be given, or the marriage is not lawful.

JACQUES

(Coming forward)

Proceed, proceed. I'll give her.

TOUCHSTONE

Good even, good Monsieur 'What-you-call'-t. How do you, sir? You are very well met. God 'ild you for your last company. I am very glad to see you. Even a toy in hand here, sir. Nay, pray be covered.

JACQUES

Will you be married, motley?



THERE LAY HE, STRETCHED ALONG LIKE A WOUNDED KNIGHT